

Syrian Activists Targeted With Facebook Phishing Attack

 eff.org/deeplinks/2012/03/pro-syrian-government-hackers-target-syrian-activists-facebook-phishing-attack

By Eva Galperin and Morgan Marquis-Boire

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Facebook has been a popular place for Syrian Internet activists to share their opposition to the Assad regime ever since the site was unblocked by the Syrian government in early 2011. While some interpreted the Assad regime's decision to allow access to Facebook as a positive sign, others feared that the government had made Facebook available for the purpose of entrapping Syrian activists.

In the past month, EFF has reported on several instances of pro-Syrian-government hackers targeting Syrian Internet activists using [malware](#) spread through chats and emails, as well as updates downloaded from a [fake YouTube site](#). Most recently, we've seen reports from Syrian opposition networking specialists of a phishing attack aimed at Syrian activists, spread primarily on pro-revolution forums on Facebook.

The screenshot below shows the phishing link accompanied by the following text in Arabic: Urgent and critical.. video leaked by security forces and thugs.. the revenge of Assad's thugs against the free men and women of Baba Amr in captivity and taking turns raping one of the women in captivity by Assad's dogs.. please spread this.

The screenshot below displays the link in a comment under a pro-revolution video. The phishing link is accompanied by the following text in Arabic: Urgent. The thug Sharif Shihada was arrested by the Free Army. Captured by Ahrar Al Qlamoun

battalion... please spread the video of him denouncing the Syrian Regime... Allahu Akbar, victory to our revolution and Free Army.

The screenshot below shows the fake Facebook login page. Note the non-Facebook URL in the URL bar of the browser.

Facebook users should be especially cautious about clicking on links in the comment sections of pro-Syrian-revolution forums, especially if they are accompanied by this text. Facebook users should beware of fake pages that resemble the Facebook login page. Always check the URL bar at the top of your browser to make sure it reads <https://www.facebook.com>. When in doubt, type <https://www.facebook.com> manually to get to Facebook.

This attack steals usernames and passwords and could potentially give an attacker access to all of the private information in your Facebook account. Syrian Facebook users should also be cautious about clicking on links sent over Facebook by their friends, whose accounts may have been compromised.

EFF is deeply concerned to see targeted attacks on Syrian Internet activists increasing in number and using increasingly diverse methods. We will continue to keep a close eye on developments.

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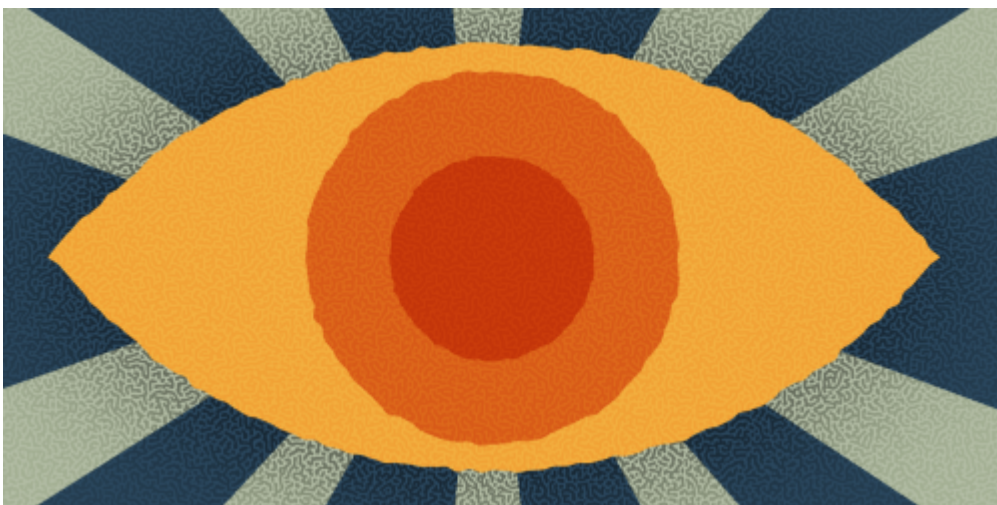
[EFF and ARTICLE 19 Submission to the European Commission on the DSA Trusted Flagger Guidelines](#)

EFF and [ARTICLE 19](#) have submitted joint comments to the European Commission on [draft guidelines](#) for the Digital Services Act's trusted flagger mechanism. Having long advocated for a DSA that protects freedom of expression while preserving intermediary liability protections and the prohibition on general monitoring, we welcome the...



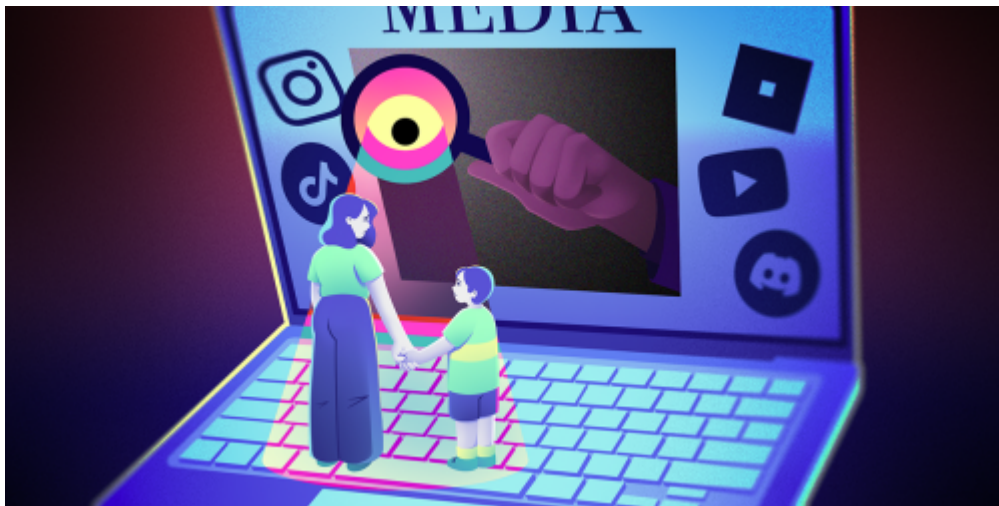
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Users are always seeking more control over their social networking experience to make it better, whether to improve privacy or enhance flexibility. Interoperability between social networking platforms like Facebook and TikTok has so many benefits that solve those issues. Say you're on multiple platforms because you have friends you follow...



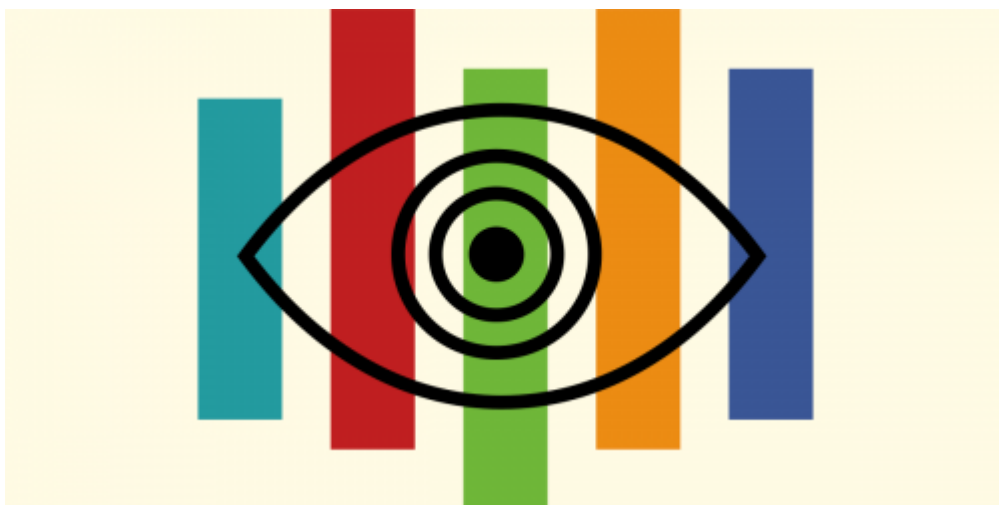
[EFF, TEDIC and CEJIL Challenge Secrecy in the Use of Face Recognition in Paraguay](#)

Seeking transparency and accountability in Paraguay's use of facial recognition, EFF, the Association of Technology, Education, Development, Research, Communication (TEDIC), and the Centre for Justice and International Law (CEJIL) filed a complaint with the Inter-American Commission on Human Rights against the state for arbitrarily denying access to information about its...



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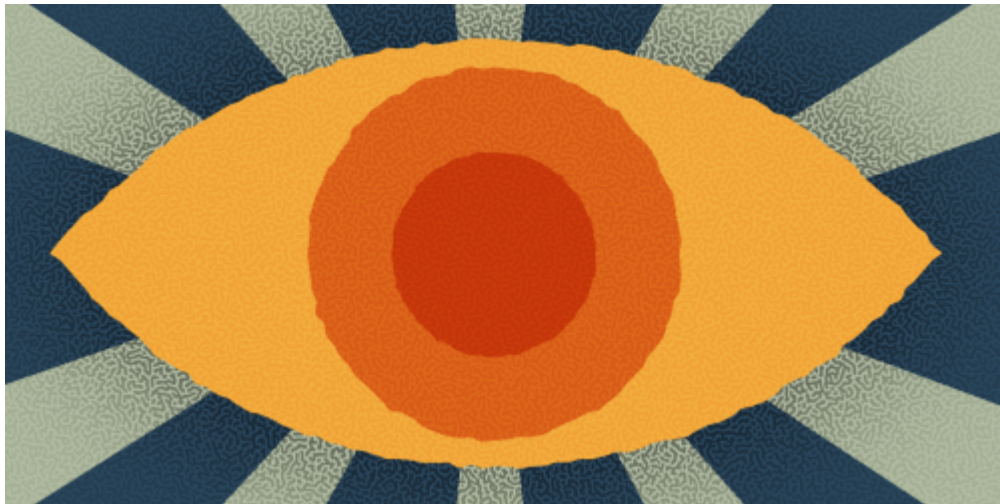
The internet is an essential resource for young people and adults to access information, explore community, and find themselves—both inside countries and across continents. Yet governments around the world continue to introduce and implement legislation requiring all online users to verify their ages before accessing the digital space.



[Deeplinks Blog](#) by [Betty Gedlu](#), Cindy Cohn | May 19, 2026

Microsoft Took a Step Toward Human Rights Accountability. Google and Amazon (and Others) Should Pay Attention!

For years, civil society organizations, workers, journalists, and human rights experts have warned that major technology companies risk enabling grave human rights abuses when they provide cloud computing, AI, and surveillance infrastructure to governments implicated in violations of international and humanitarian law. While many companies pay lip service to evaluating...



We Must Not Normalize Digital Surveillance Abuses. EFF's New Guide Underlines Concrete Steps to Fight Back.

Poor accountability, feeble control mechanisms, and insufficient legal frameworks have led to systematic human rights violations in the Americas, with no consistent remedy or reparation to victims. What's needed is to materialize essential guarantees and measures to combat repeated surveillance abuses in the region. To help build a path...



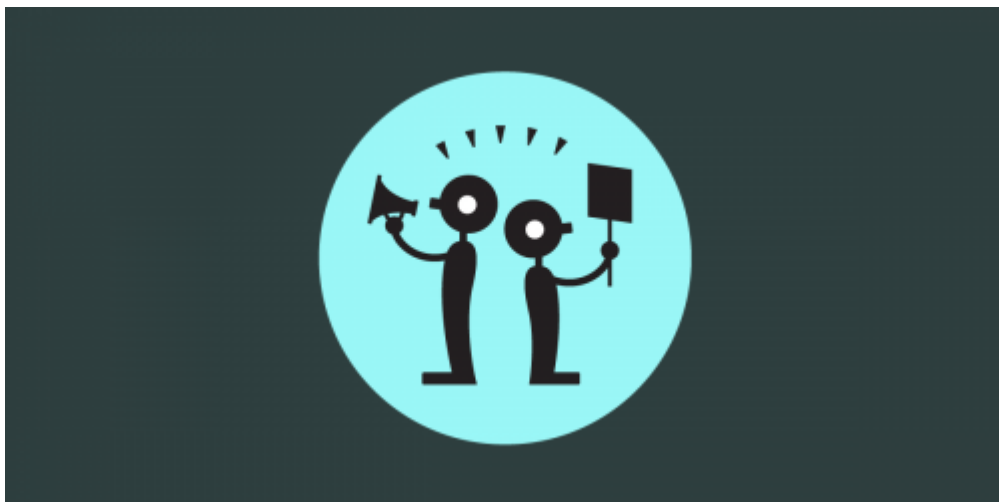
[EFF Launches New Offline Campaign for Saudi Wikipedian Osama Khalid](#)

Osama Khalid was just twelve years old when he began contributing to Wikipedia Arabic. In the height of the blogging era, he became a prolific blogger, publishing writings on his home country of Saudi Arabia, meetups he attended, and his opinions and observations about open source technology and freedom of...



[A Hackers Guide to Circumventing Internet Shutdowns](#)

Internet shutdowns are devastating for human rights. We can't rely on tech oligarchs to save us, especially when these same companies and governments are the ones to sever our access to the internet and telecommunications. This is why it's important to set up communication mechanisms before a disaster happens.



[Deeplinks Blog](#) by Electronic Frontier Foundation | May 11, 2026

[EFF Stands in Solidarity With RightsCon and the Global Digital Rights Community](#)

The abrupt cancellation of RightsCon 2026—the world’s largest annual global digital rights conference—is not just a logistical disruption for thousands of participants—it is part of a growing global pattern of shrinking civic space and increasing hostility toward free expression and independent civil society.



[EFF and 18 Organizations Urge UK Policymakers to Prioritize Addressing the Roots of Online Harm](#)

EFF joins 18 organizations in writing a letter to UK policymakers urging them to address the root causes of online harm—rather than undermining the open web through blunt restrictions.